

CONTENT-CAPACITY CONTRACT

# Count first, then choose.

*Every layout declares how many elements it holds — so you pick by content shape, and the linter warns before an overflow.*

# The slip that causes overflow.

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## **Pick by intent only**

The agent matches the topic to a layout's tags and skeleton, never counting how many elements the content actually has.

## **Pour in too much**

Eight items land in a grid built for three or four; the slide silently overflows its frame.

## **Catch it too late**

The red overflow ring only shows up at render — long after the layout was chosen.

# A grid at its sweet spot.

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**Confidence**

How sure are we the signal is real? Scored one to five each week.

**Recency**

How fresh is the signal? Decays as the data ages.

**Relevance**

How much does it move the strategy? Weighted by the team.

# Too many? Escalate, don't cram.

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|    |                                     |                                              |
|----|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 01 | Confidence — is the signal real?    | Scored one to five every week.               |
| 02 | Recency — how fresh is it?          | Decays as the data ages.                     |
| 03 | Relevance — does it move strategy?  | Weighted by the team and reviewed quarterly. |
| 04 | Coverage — how complete is intake?  | Tracked against the source checklist.        |
| 05 | Cost — what did it take to collect? | Logged for the calibration loop.             |

## The contract, in four numbers.

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**axis**

THE COLLECTION THAT  
CROWDS — ITEM, ROW, COL,  
CELL OR LINE.

**sweet**

THE IDEAL COUNT,  
SURFACED TO THE  
AUTHOR.

**soft**

PAST HERE IT  
CROWDS — A SOFT  
WARNING FIRES.

**hard**

PAST HERE IT  
OVERFLOWS — THE LOUD  
WARNING FIRES.

# The warning reads like a fix.

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```
△ deck.md · slide 4 · capacity-overflow [cards-grid]
  'cards-grid' holds about 3 items comfortably (max ~5);
  this slide has 8 – it will overflow
  fix: Switch to list-tabular, or split across slides.
```

# The author's loop.

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## STEP 01

### Count

How many items, rows, columns, or code lines does the content have?



## STEP 02

### Check

Read the component's capacity in `components.pick.md` — sweet/soft/hard.



## STEP 03

### Choose

Within capacity, keep it; over hard, take an `escalateTo` target or split.

“

*Pick the layout by shape, not by vibe — the number of elements decides it as much as the topic does.*

”

— The content-capacity contract